



European Central PMO Lead – Unified CPMO Service Design

As European Central PMO Lead, I was responsible for identifying, designing, and implementing a unified Central Project Management Office (CPMO) service based out of the Belgium headquarters to support European clients.

This initiative established a scalable, compliant, and high-performance PMO model aligned with ISO, GDPR, and secure client requirements across multiple jurisdictions.

Programme Overview

The CPMO initiative aimed to standardise project governance, assurance, and delivery across European operations.

The goal was to create a single, unified PMO framework capable of supporting diverse client environments while maintaining compliance with international standards and local regulatory obligations.

Key objectives:

- Design a unified CPMO service model for European clients
- Align operations with ISO, CMS, and GDPR requirements
- Establish governance, assurance, and delivery frameworks
- Create scalable cost models and benefit realisation structures
- Implement training, onboarding, and people development frameworks

Service Design & Compliance Framework

The CPMO service was designed to operate within a secure, compliant environment, integrating multiple regulatory and operational requirements.

Activities:

- ISO & CMS Alignment – embedding quality and compliance standards into PMO processes
- Secure Client Requirements – ensuring data protection and confidentiality across borders
- GDPR Considerations – implementing privacy-by-design principles and data handling protocols
- Service Descriptions & SLAs – defining measurable service levels and delivery commitments

This created a robust foundation for consistent, auditable PMO operations across all European territories.

Commercial Modelling & Benefit Realisation

To support scalability and commercial viability, I developed detailed cost and benefit models for new client proposals.

Deliverables:

- Scalable cost models for multi-country PMO services
- ROI and benefit realisation frameworks
- Commercial validation with finance and delivery leads

- Integration into proposal and bid documentation

These models ensured that each client engagement was both profitable and operationally sustainable.

Competency & Capability Development

I led the initial assessment and adoption of the APM Competency Maturity Assessment Framework, aligning PMO capability development with Continuing Professional Development (CPD) standards.

Outcomes:

- Competency mapping across PMO roles
- CPD-aligned training pathways
- Development of course content and training materials
- Implementation of a people development framework

This approach elevated PMO maturity and professional standards across the European organisation.

Governance, Assurance & Delivery Frameworks

I designed and implemented comprehensive governance and assurance processes to underpin PMO operations.

Deliverables:

- Governance and assurance frameworks
- Delivery processes and supporting templates
- Toolkits for project initiation, planning, and reporting
- Integration with HR and business onboarding processes

These frameworks ensured consistent delivery quality and compliance across all projects.

Recruitment & Organisational Setup

As part of the CPMO establishment, I managed team recruitment and organisational setup, ensuring compliance with local employment regulations.

Responsibilities:

- Recruitment strategy and candidate selection
- Coordination with HR and legal teams
- Compliance with German Workers Council requirements
- Onboarding and induction process design

This ensured a compliant, well-structured PMO team capable of supporting pan-European delivery.

Project Management Platform Ownership

I acted as Service Owner for the identification, design, and implementation of the Project Management Platform.

Key activities:

- Platform assessment and selection
- Procurement and contractual negotiation with third-party vendors
- Test build and implementation oversight
- Integration with CPMO governance and reporting processes

The platform became the backbone of project visibility, reporting, and assurance across the European PMO network.

Transition & Handover

Upon successful implementation, I managed the handover to France for AIS (Application Integration Services), ensuring continuity of service and knowledge transfer.

Deliverables:

- Operational handover documentation
- Knowledge transfer sessions
- Transition governance and assurance sign-off

 Strategic Impact

The European CPMO initiative delivered a unified, compliant, and scalable PMO service capable of supporting complex multinational clients.

It strengthened European delivery capability, improved governance maturity, and established a foundation for continuous improvement and professional development across the PMO community.